

Homage to Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets

Toh 767 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 767 in the Kangyur is a short canonical scripture known in Tibetan as Gsang ba'i bdag po rdo rje bsnams pa, addressed to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, and concerned with the various epithets and synonyms of Vaiśravaṇa, the great king of gods and guardian of the northern region. The text takes the form of a teaching prompted by the yakṣa general Samyakjñāna, who poses a series of questions about why Vaiśravaṇa bears names such as Son of Vaiśravaṇa, Restful, Guardian of the Region, and Ugly Body, with the Buddha directing Vajrapāṇi himself to provide the explanations before the assembled host of yakṣas. As the opening homage and framing suggest, it belongs to the broader class of tantric or tantra-adjacent texts associated with Vajrapāṇi and the yakṣa retinue. The text was translated at the great monastery of Tholing by Rabzhi, a direct disciple of the Indian master Dhānagupta.

This was translated at Tholing by the direct disciple of the master Dhānagupta, the lord of Dharma-vajra, the great translator Rabzhi.

Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets.

Then the great yakṣa general Samyakjñāna circumambulated the Blessed One many times, offered him divine flowers and many precious jewels, and praised him openly. Then he spoke thus: "Blessed One, why is this king of gods called Son of Vaiśravaṇa? Why is he called Restful? Why is he called Guardian of the Region? Why is he called Ugly Body?"

When this was asked, the Blessed One spoke to Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, you yourself should explain to this great assembly of yakṣas and to the great general Samyakjñāna the various synonyms of the king of gods, exactly and completely." Having declared this, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, then circumambulated the Blessed One many times and, filled with vajra-pride, strode about and took his seat. He looked out over the assembled retinue and the great yakṣa generals, and spoke thus to the great yakṣa general Samyakjñāna:

"General Samyakjñāna, this king of gods is an emanation from the mind of the Tathāgata Vairocana, performing the deeds of a buddha just as a buddha would perform them."

Then Brahmā Viśeṣamati thought to himself: "How wonderful. By what means might the aspirations of the gods be fulfilled and the hopes of human beings be satisfied?" And he reflected thus: The Great God (Śiva), Mahādeva, lord of all the gods, was dwelling in the grove of joy, devoted to the conduct of a sage. He was widely known among the divine sons as the Great Sage who had been heard of in many forms, one who practiced the conduct of a sage. At that time Brahmā Viśeṣamati urged Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), and a glorious goddess was offered to the sage. Through this, the sage was turned away from his ascetic practice. Having dwelt with Śruta-bahudhā, after ten months a boy bearing auspicious marks appeared miraculously in the lap of the glorious goddess. He was given the name Siddhartha. When he had grown, the gods of the four divisions of the Great Kings presented him at the palace of Alakāvatī and consecrated him as king of the third level. At that time the gods dwelling in the sky, Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa, Dhanada, and Yakṣa Vajrapāṇi and the others offered him a brilliant jeweled chariot and praised him:

Protector of gods and men, god above gods,
beneficent Siddhartha, son of Śruta-bahudhā,
rich in power of aspiration, compassion, and jewels —
to the son of Śruta-bahudhā I bow in homage.

Through this praise and homage, the name "Son of Vaiśravaṇa" came to be established. As for the great general Samyakjñāna, the gods desired the daughters of the asuras, while the asuras desired the fruit of the trees belonging to the gods, and so these two sides came to fight. The asuras had four great stations in the cavities of Mount Meru: the first was Rāhu's station, the second was Galanecklace, the third was Prahāsa, and the fourth was Suvarṇābha. Then the lord of the asuras, Rāhu, arrayed with his great host of troops, moved to attack the gods of the four Great Kings. At that time the king, Son of Vaiśravaṇa, rested and looked out over Jambudvīpa, thoroughly surveying it. He engaged in battle with Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa, and Dhanada.

At that time, the Son of Vaiśravaṇa was resting at the waist of Mount Meru, and Rāhu, beholding him, could not bear the splendor and majesty he saw. Then Rāhu scattered various precious flowers and offered this praise:

Among the gods, O Wealth-God, supreme among gods,
Protector of beings, you who rest in virtue,
Fulfiller of hopes who walks the Sugata's way,
Guardian of all — to you who rest I bow.

Having praised him thus, he offered the aspiration, "May the king, the reposer of the three worlds, be victorious," and then withdrew to his own abode. Through that true knowledge, the name "the Reposer" came to be established.

Then the great commander Yandak-she, stationed in the second land of the asuras, Galanecklace, said to Rāhu: "Rāhu, did you gain firmness in battle? Did you return in ease?" Rāhu replied: "I was burned by the splendor of the king, the Reposer — scorched, and barely able to endure it."

At that time Galanecklace, overcome by anger, said to Rāhu: "O Rāhu, my strength and host of troops are four times greater than yours. Let us go together and destroy the cities and pleasure gardens and parks of the Four Great Kings." Then he set out, accompanied by Rāhu and an immeasurable host of troops.

At that time King Son of Vaiśravaṇa had mounted a lion and was arrayed in golden armor. When the three kings and those of Prahāsa were seized upon and reached, the Son of Vaiśravaṇa himself guarded his own realm and the stations such as Joyful Supreme and the rest, and defeated the asuras.

Then the lord of the asuras, Galanecklace, scattered various precious garments and offered this praise:

Hero without fear, victorious in battle over affliction,
Guardian of the gods' domain, lion-throned and overpowering,
Liberator of the destitute, adorned with the five kinds of armor,
Protector and guardian of the realm — to you I bow.

Having praised him thus, he withdrew to his own abode.

Then Prahāsa, dwelling in the third asura land, said to Galanecklace: "Did the lord of the asuras win in battle? Did he gain firmness?" Galanecklace replied: "We, the masters of the asuras — we along with Rāhu — were utterly defeated by the protector and guardian of the realm. He made us tremble like a grove of trees in water, and crushed us like flowers struck by hail."

Prahāsa then said: "I shall devastate the beautiful city of the lord of the gods and subjugate the Four Great Kings." So saying, he went to the summit of Mount Meru accompanied by his own great host of troops along with Rāhu and Galanecklace, exceeding the previous force a hundredfold and more.

At that time the lord of gods, Śakra (Indra), was in the Dharma-fine land, teaching the Dharma to the divine sons. Then the three lords of the asuras, together with their armies, seized and reached the city of Sudarśana and its

pleasure gardens.

At that time the thirty-two attendants reported to Śakra: "May the lord of gods please be informed: the asuras have seized the city of Sudarśana." Śakra replied: "Let the divine lords go and appeal to the king of the north, the Reposer. He will bring victory in battle." Then the thirty-two attendants said: "O Great King, the lord of gods calls upon you to bring victory in battle against the asuras."

At that time King Ngal-so-po, beholding Mount Meru in all its golden splendor and beauty —

— and its lapis lazuli beauty, his own body clad in lapis lazuli, he mounted a horse of lapis lazuli hue, adorned with golden trappings, and set forth to do battle.

At that time, the Laughter and the others could not endure his splendor, and, defeated of their own accord, they departed through that very gate of the earth and returned to their own realm.

At that time the gods of the Thirty-Three marveled and said: "How extraordinary — with such a wretched body he has won victory in battle against the asuras!" Perfectly understanding this, the gods of the four Great Kings have bodies measuring four times the range of a bowshot; the gods of the Thirty-Three have bodies measuring half a bowshot. The body of the Reposer accordingly did not reach even half the measure of the body of a god of the Thirty-Three. Then the thirty-two attendants scattered many jeweled flowers and offered this praise:

Among the gods, O King — Wealth-God, you —
are the refuge of all who wish and hope.

With a wretched body you tamed the ten millions of asuras;
homage to you, victorious in the battle of afflictions.

Having praised him thus, they proclaimed: "King Wretched-Body has become our refuge" — and it is for that reason he is called Wretched-Body.

Commander Samyakjñāna, know well the synonyms by which these three kings are named. This is the eleventh chapter of the Latter Examination of the Lord of Yakṣas and Dancers Supreme, the chapter that teaches the synonyms of the names of the son of Vaiśravaṇa.

Then the commander Samyakjñāna, with a mind full of joy, addressed the Lord of Secrets thus: "Please explain the method of accomplishment by which

human beings may become wealthy and gods may have their poverty dispelled." Having heard this request, the Lord of Secrets smiled and spoke to the lords of yakṣas:

"Excellent, Commander Samyakjñāna! This is the ritual procedure for accomplishing that — the bodhisattva Ratnamañjuśrī, renowned as Vairocana's Glorious Garland, arisen from his mind:

In an isolated and secluded place, seat yourself at ease upon a comfortable seat. Having bathed and put on clean garments, make full offerings with all manner of worship. At the heart center, the syllable HŪṂ; from it rays of boundless light radiate forth. Buddhas, those of awakening mind, and the rest, śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and the protectors of beings — these appear vividly before you. Make prostrations, go for refuge, and so forth. Then, cultivating loving-kindness and the rest in recollection, rest in ease, arisen from the unwavering wisdom of emptiness.

Then, through aspiration and compassion, upon a seven-horse chariot, with the sound of dragon-thunder, resides the five-pointed vajra itself. From it, a fully perfect body — the body's hue a yellow-green, the color of vaidūrya; the hero's face both smiling and wrathful, elegant and adorned with ornaments, beautified by wisdom and meditative absorption.

Before him stands Vajranartana, his body deep blue, adorned with serpents, holding a vajra in the right hand and a sword in the left.

Then the great mighty Vidyā who destroys the three realms, red of body, holding a vajra and a victory fan, stands close on his right side.

On his left side stands the wrathful one who conquers māras throughout the three realms, white, wielding a wheel and a staff.

At the back, the one who joins nectar with the fire — green, holding a vajra of many kinds.

In the corners and the spaces between them: elegant goddesses with garlands, dance and song, incense, flowers, and lamps — in the arcade and at the pavilion's corners.

Keepers of the gates — hook and the rest — beautified by wisdom and meditative absorption.

Perfectly arisen from the seed syllable HŪṂ — transformed through fire, wind, and water into space — is a measureless palace, beautiful with five walls of

wisdom. Its lord, in the manner of a hero, surrounded by an entourage of sixteen,

Its secret mantra is as follows:

Om vajra caṇḍa sarva duṣṭānātaka hana daha paca hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajra krodha sambharāja hūṃ. Om vajra krodha hana daha gupta pidhvaṃsaya jāṭilaṃ bodhara hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajra krodha trailokya vijaya hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajra krodha amṛtakuṇḍali hana hana hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajra lāsye hūṃ. Om vajra māle trāṃ. Om vajra gīti hrīḥ. Om vajra nṛti aḥ. Om vajra dhūpe hūṃ. Om vajra puṣpe trāṃ. Om vajra āloke hrīḥ. Om vajra gandhe aḥ. Om vajra aṅkuśa jaḥ. Om vajra pāśa hūṃ. Om vajra sphoṭa baṃ. Om vajra ghaṇṭe hoḥ.

Having made offerings with these mantras, if one recites them in their entirety one hundred thousand times, great awakening will be attained. One obtains a sword, eye-medicine, swift-footedness, pills of invisibility together with their essence, a fine vase, gold-transmutation, and the eight spiritual accomplishments. Even divine servants come to attend. These and all other qualities will arise from this awareness-mantra.

This is the seventeenth chapter, being the twelfth, from the Latter Tantra of the Noble Yakṣa-General.

Now the correct practice of the king of the third place — the great general who knows truly — shall be properly explained.

In a place of great seclusion, having seated oneself comfortably on a pleasant seat, one visualizes a HŪṂ at one's own heart, like the sun. From its light, beings are purified. One makes offerings and praises to the teacher, the buddha, is fully endowed with the four immeasurables, and is made stable by emptiness.

Then the HŪṂ, rendered into one with rays of heat, emits light together with the vajra HŪṂ syllable. Through this transformation, the Lord of Secrets arises: his body color is greenish-yellow, with a gentle wrathfulness. He holds a vajra and a blue lotus. He is to be contemplated as the very embodiment from whom Amitābha radiates abundantly.

Then, in front of him, a measureless palace arises from the syllable BHRŪṂ, furnished with eighty-four thousand pillars, built from the four precious substances, its pinnacle adorned above with jewels, with nine tiered palaces rising at the four corners, and beautifully ornamented with fine pools in the spaces between the central and peripheral sections.

At the center, upon a lion throne that inspires awe, one contemplates the Lord of the three planes born from the vajra, the king of the gods. From the heart of the principal figure already described, light radiates forth, drawing in and absorbing primordial wisdom. Endowed with the three bodies, one blesses the six sites with vajra consecration in accordance with that very reality. One offers homage and praise to him, and pleases him with the essence-mantra:

Oṃ vajrapāṇi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vaiśravaṇāya svāhā.

Like a wheel of fire blazing in a circle, endowed with the three kinds of clarity, if one makes offerings while knowing this very reality, the protector of the three planes will be greatly pleased, will accomplish whatever is desired, and one hundred thousand recitations will shake the planes of existence. The yakṣas dwelling on mountains will become one's servants.

Two hundred thousand recitations will cause dwelling-places to blaze. The yakṣas dwelling in the atmosphere will become one's servants, obeying whatever commands one speaks.

Three hundred thousand recitations will burn the directions, and one's fame will spread and pervade the ten directions.

Four hundred thousand recitations will bring attainment of food and drink. The daughters of the yakṣa gods will offer service to the awareness-holder in the form of women.

Five hundred thousand recitations: the nāgas dwelling beneath the earth will cause a rain of wealth and grain to fall.

Six hundred thousand recitations: an excellent retinue and gains will be obtained. The yakṣas who abide in the Dharma will appear in the form of human children.

Seven hundred thousand recitations: the lineage of awareness will increase. The gods endowed with the Dharma will take birth for the benefit of sentient beings.

Eight hundred thousand recitations: life will increase, and the thirty-two great powers, the twenty-eight great generals,

following them will remove obstacles. Nine hundred thousand recitations: the quintessence medicines will be found. The great yakṣa awareness-holders, in order to increase their power and longevity through this, will abide in the true form of physicians. One million recitations: supernormal knowledge (abhijñā)

will be attained, and one will be filled with all excellent qualities.

This is the thirteenth chapter of the Latter Tantra of the Chief Yakṣa Dancer, which teaches the benefits of the secret mantra of Vajrapāṇi, the guide of beings.

O Great Commander, know well: this profound rite of awareness accomplishes all works without effort. Whatever person one praises with a tooth-stick and bestows it upon will come under one's power. If a piece of kuśa-root wood is burned together with thick rice gruel and bezoar, wealth will increase.

This very awareness-mantra of the eighth letter, written clearly upon a golden tablet and fitted into a copper amulet-case, then placed within a wheel together with honey, and held in the hand with the transmission seal and mudrā, and recited one million times — the qualities taught above will arise; of this there is no doubt.

As for the sādhana of that wheel, one may also take a treasury chamber, a square house most beautifully adorned, painted with many-hued pigments, smeared throughout with red sandalwood fragrance, a fathom wide and three cubits tall. In the center, place five vases filled with five grains, and on the tenth day of the waxing moon of each month make offerings and supplications — this will cause heaps of wealth to increase. This is the sādhana of the treasury, a heap of treasure.

Again, place that same wheel upon a multi-spoked vajra set in the center of a hearth, and draw the images of four full vases on the four sides and four walls of the hearth, and draw four cows on the four sides. If one heats it with a fire of sengdeng wood, abundance will be made inexhaustible.

Again, if that wheel is concealed in a temple, the yakṣa who has been accomplished will manifest directly.

Again, if that wheel is concealed in the treasury of a wealthy person without him knowing, heaps of grain will be transported to one's own home of themselves.

Again, if that wheel is concealed at the birthplace of a queen, and supplication is made with the transmission seal before the goddess Śrī Devī, the family lineage of whoever has offered the supplication will increase.

This is the fourteenth chapter of the Latter Tantra of the Chief Yakṣa Dancer, which teaches the collection of activities of the eighth letter.

O Great Commander, know well: those who wish to increase heaps of grain should accomplish the goddess Śrī Devī. To the northeast of the palace of the king of the gods Śakra (Indra), in a sublime golden mansion called the Victory Banner, Śrī Devī abides. There the Tathāgata Suvarṇadhvaja of Jambudvīpa received the Sky-Treasury meditative absorption and became a great patron.

From the syllable Hūṃ, in the center of a beautiful jeweled palace, one should visualize nine lotuses with nine vases resting upon them. Upon the central vase, from the syllable Śrī, the goddess appears — the color of fresh green kuśa grass, adorned with all ornaments. In her right hand she holds a lotus adorned with jewels; her left hand bears the mudrā of granting refuge. Around her, upon the eight outer vases, are eight companions: Norgyünma, Dzelshélcen, Jinjedma, Rapjinma, Phagma, Bepamo, Rabzangma, and Lhamo Yangcenma. These too are to be visualized in the full bloom of youth, endowed with an alluring grace, golden in color, holding vases and sheaves of grain, surrounded by their own beloved attendant retinues.

For the manifest accomplishment of their essence, recite:

tadyathā —

jini grīṇi sarva akāryasiddhani si si mi sili sini mi ni mi alakṣayāme nāśaye
svāhā oṃ vāsudhāriṇyai svāhā oṃ candrakāntyai svāhā oṃ dādāyai svāhā oṃ
āryāyai svāhā oṃ subhadrāyai svāhā oṃ gubhāyai svāhā oṃ devyai svāhā oṃ
sarasvatyai svāhā

For the great manifest accomplishment of the bodhisattva conduct of those yakṣas, first perform a preliminary recitation of one hundred thousand, then before the glorious goddess perform a burnt offering of white sesame in a fire pit with various rites upon a fruit-bearing tree. If the ash from that is scattered into a granary, it causes a great heap of grain to multiply.

Make an image of the glorious goddess filled with the color of white sandalwood, then wrap it together with the five precious substances, a measure of grain, and yellow silk, and place it in the hand. After reciting one hundred thousand times, place it upon a heap of grain in the storehouse. On special occasions, offer honey, molasses, and milk as worship, and make supplication, and a great heap of grain will increase.

This is the fifteenth chapter, the chapter on the glorious goddess multiplying heaps of grain, from the latter tantra of the noble master of dance among the yakṣas.

Then another accomplishment of the great yakṣa will be explained. What is it? From the complete transformation of the expanse of wind, fire, and earth, together with the mountains of Meru, into a divine palace — arising from the arrangement of Cālavana (the Forest of the Moving Leaves), with four successive platforms — in the center, from a HŪṂ completely transformed, a vajra arises, and from the HŪṂ together with that, one should visualize the wrathful king clad in blue: possessing eight faces, eight feet, and sixteen arms, the form of a dark-blue child, adorned with all ornaments.

Of the eight faces: those on the right are yellow, those on the left are green, those in the center are dark blue, and the rear face is red. Above those, the three upper faces: the right is white, the left is red, and the central one is like a blue utpala lotus. Above that is a peaceful face adorned with ornaments, dark blue in color, endowed with the quality of Akṣobhya.

In the hands he bears a vajra, a vajra club, an elephant's tusk, the wheel of Viṣṇu, an iron hook, a boulder, and a fire pit — these are in the right hands. The left hands hold a great vessel with the threatening finger gesture, a conch shell, a lasso, a splendor-wood torch, a five-pronged throwing spear, and a victory banner. Standing upon a crystal throne, with eight dancing postures he stamps his feet, and one visualizes the eight great nāgas as his seat, all of them trembling completely.

Before him, his companion at rest:

Born perfectly from a vajra,
well-seated upon a lion throne,
adorned with golden-colored precious ornaments.
In the right hand, a precious victory banner;
in the left, a reliquary casket held most excellently.
Radiating boundless rays of light,
dwelling in the very center, burning what is wicked,
together with the lord of his own family,
he abides, accomplished from nondual primordial wisdom.

All the assembled hosts of many yakṣas one should visualize as his own retinue.

In front, Jambhala of golden color, holding a mongoose and a blazing jewel. To the right, Gaṅgabhadra of golden color, holding a mongoose and a vase. Behind, Ratnabhadra, white in color, holding a mongoose and a jewel-sheaf. To the left, Aśvapati Kubera, dark in color, holding a mongoose and a sword.

Samyakjña, yellow, holding a mongoose and a jewel-knife. Droṅāga, black, holding a mongoose and a jewel-spear. Pañcika, tawny yellow, holding a mongoose and a many-storied palace. Krīḍāvṛtta, white in color, holding a mongoose and a knife-sheath.

All of these dwell upon horses and accomplish the purposes of those who hold the knowledge mantras.

Between the three outer rings dwell the twenty-eight commanders. Those of long form, good eyes, Gaṅga, and Serkha reside in the east. Siṃha, Upasiṃha, Dungchen, and Gawa reside in the south. Siṃha, Lion-maned, and Serkha Lama reside in the west. Dzinpa, Dzindga, Tsönkyong, and Khyabjug reside in the north. In the northeast is Nalcod; in the southeast, Tsikha Serpo; in the southwest, Riñam; in the northwest, Serchen. These belong to the jewel family.

Further: in the east, Ba; in the south, Śintu Sapa; in the west, Nagpo; in the north, Nyenag. These belong to the cattle family. In the northeast, Sun; in the southeast, Moon; in the southwest, Fire; in the northwest, Wind. These too belong to the cattle family.

These twenty-eight commanders all hold knives and sheaths, are dark red in color, and are slightly wrathful in appearance.

Beyond them, one visualizes thirty-two mighty ones: Indra, Moon, Water-Moon, Lord of Beings, Vairadhāja, Powerful One, Candana, and Lord of Desire — these reside in the east. Mgrinṅan, Mguṅges, Badi, Jewel, Jewel-Wielder, Sgrarab, Nyeṅapo, and Riñam — these reside in the south. Serchen, Gaṅga, Sengdeng, Yöñchok Lha, Balangkyong, Drognéd, King of Humans, and Supreme Herd of Victors — these reside in the west. Tsikha Serpo, Zhinnzang, Ringpo, Gandharva of Various Kinds, Drebu Sumpa, Mguṅsumpa, Iron Long-Spear, and Lha-born Maldén — these reside in the north. These belong to the earthbound family and are the generals of the armies of the restorative king.

The thirty-two great mighty ones are visualized as dark greenish in color, clad in armor, and holding spears and swords.

Outside them, one visualizes a measureless host of yakṣas, decayed bodies, and rākṣasas.

Having thus visualized the great assemblies of yakṣas, one recites the knowledge mantra:

This supreme knowledge mantra, authorized by as many buddhas as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā, has never arisen before and shall not arise hereafter. Apart from this, all other knowledge mantras are like essence-less husks and match nothing.

Tadyathā: oṃ bho bho pannāga adhipataye phu phu hara hara nāgānāṃ phu phu prahara nāgānāṃ phu phu chinda chinda nāgaḥṛdayāni phu phu bhinda nāgadāmani bisima mandha nāgaśarīraṇi visphoṭaya nāganayanāni hasa hasa dhara dhara mārāya nāśaya sarvavig hṇa vināśakarāya sarvaśatruṃ saṃgha vināśakarāya phaṭ oṃ nīlāmbara dhara vajrapāṇi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

Having thus delighted the Blessed One with this authentic knowledge mantra, this is the authorization given by the buddhas who perfectly pacify the assemblies of nāgas, yakṣas, and blazing spirits. The holder of this supreme knowledge mantra, having practiced it in this way, accomplishes whatever is desired.

The Lord of Secrets then spoke again:

Great and restorative, powerful in virtue,
Wondrous king of secret mantras,
Supreme commander of all the gods —
Now the knowledge mantra of that one is set forth.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namo vaiśravaṇāya mahārājāya. Tadyathā: oṃ simi simi sumu sumu caṇḍa caṇḍa cara cara sara sara kara kara kili kili kulu kulu muru muru curu curu sādahaya ātmananīyad.

andhara dhā hū svāhā. Namo vaiśravaṇāya svāhā. Dhanadāye svāhā. Namo rathavari vūrāya svāhā.

This knowledge mantra of the commander, the perfect knower and king, causes all desired aims to arise without effort. It is approved by all the buddhas.

Furthermore, the great precious treasury
That fulfills all wishes
And dispels the misery of beings —
That I shall now fully expound.

Oṃ vaiśravaṇāya svāhā. Oṃ jambhala jalendrāya svāhā. Oṃ pūrṇabhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ maṇibhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ kuberāya svāhā. Oṃ saṃbhrajanāya svāhā. Oṃ guhyadhanāya svāhā. Oṃ vāṅcikāya svāhā. Oṃ cipikuṇḍalaye svāhā.

This knowledge mantra is the supreme bestower. It was spoken by the Lord of Secrets for the benefit of gods in misery and humans in misery.

This is the sixteenth chapter, on accomplishing the armies and troops of the restorative forces of the yakṣas, from the latter section of the Tantra of the Supreme Yakṣa Dancer.

The Blessed One then spoke words of praise to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi: "Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you have, through the many synonyms of names, reasonings, accomplishments, and analyses regarding the restorative forces, taught the enumeration of names for the benefit of gods in misery and humans in misery in times to come."

When the Blessed One had thus declared this, Vajraessence and the other bodhisattvas who had come from the ten directions, the great śrāvakas headed by Śāriputra, Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), the Lord of Joy, and the rest, together with gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — the entire world rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

The Tantra of the Supreme Yakṣa Dancer is complete.

Translated into Tibetan at the ornament of Tholing, the monastery of Spontaneous Accomplishment, by the Kashmiri scholar Dānagupta and the Tibetan translator Rapzhi.

Translator's Notes

- The name "Alakāvatī" (Alakāvatī, the willow-leafed palace) is the traditional name of Vaiśravaṇa's celestial residence; this is rendered by its standard Sanskrit name for clarity. The narrative of Mahādeva's encounter with Brahmā and Śakra leading to the birth of Vaiśravaṇa's son follows a distinct mythological account that interweaves cosmological and quasi-hagiographic elements; the figure "Śruta-bahudhā" ("Heard-of-in-many-forms," here a glorious goddess) is a semi-personified epithet rendered literally. The phrase "king of the third level" likely refers to the third tier of the realm of the Four Great Kings within the Meru cosmology. The names of the four asura strongholds are translated from context; "Thagbzang-ris" is rendered as "Suvarṇābha" (golden-hued) tentatively. The phrase "son of Śruta-bahudhā, i.e., "Son of the Many-heard") directly explains the etymology of the epithet "Vaiśravaṇa" (son of Viśravaṇa / widely heard), which is the doctrinal point of the passage.
- The epithet "Ngal-so-po" rendered throughout as "the Reposer" follows directly from the preceding narrative, where the name is explained as arising from the act of resting (ngal bso ba) at Mount Meru's waist. The passage ends mid-sentence with the king beholding Mount Meru; this is intentional, as it is a narrative break in the source.

"Yandak-she" (yang dag shes) is a proper name for the great commander; it literally means "one who knows correctly," but as it functions as a name here it is transliterated rather than

translated.

"Joyful Supreme" renders kun dga' rab, which appears to be a place name among the asura stations; the standard Sanskrit equivalent would be Nandottara.

- The epithet "Wealth-God" renders རྒྱལ་ལྷ་, a recognized alternate name for Vaiśravaṇa or a yakṣa king associated with wealth — contextually the Reposer here praised. The name "Vairocana's Glorious Garland" renders རྒྱལ་ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་ལྷ་, a specific epithet of the bodhisattva Ratnamañjuśrī in this ritual context; the identification is given by the Tibetan text itself.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text is evidently a continuation; the translation closes where the Tibetan breaks off.

- The chapter colophon identifies this as chapter seventeen, being "the twelfth," which reflects a secondary numbering system within the tantra and is translated as given without alteration.

The phrase rendered "the Lord of the three planes born from the vajra" refers to Vaiśravaṇa as king of the yakṣas ruling over the three planes; the Sanskrit underlying "born from the vajra" (vajra-ja) is a standard epithet in this tantra cycle.

The "three kinds of clarity" is a technical tantric term likely referring to clarity of body, speech, and mind visualization; a more specific commentarial gloss is not available from the text alone.

- The eight companion goddesses are given in Tibetan functional names rather than recognized Sanskrit names, so I have rendered them in transliteration rather than attempted Sanskrit back-formation. Their names mean roughly: Stream of Wealth, Moon-Crystal, Giver, Supreme Giver, Noble One, Hidden One, Supremely Good, and the Goddess Sarasvatī (Yangcenma). A specialist may wish to identify Sanskrit equivalents from parallel texts.

The term "eighth letter" is a technical esoteric designation for a specific syllable of the mantra; its precise referent depends on the root text's syllable-count and is left as given.

The wood "sengdeng" is likely Acacia catechu or a related species used in fire-offerings; it is a standard ritual fuel in this literature.

- The passage opens with a dhāraṇī in transliterated Sanskrit. The syllables are rendered phonetically as they appear in the Tibetan transcription, following standard scholarly practice for such mantra sequences; individual semantic parsing of the dhāraṇī syllables is not attempted, as they function as sacred sound-formulas.

The term rendered "reliquary casket" for sku gdung is literally "body relic"; in the iconographic context of a deity holding an object, it refers to a stūpa-shaped relic container or reliquary.

"Cālavana" is a tentative reconstruction for lcam lo can; the term more commonly means "willow grove" or "grove of lcam trees," but in the context of yakṣa cosmology it may correspond to a named divine forest. The Sanskrit reconstruction is plausible but not certain.

The names of the eight companion yakṣa-deities in the final section (Jambhala, Gaṅgabhadra, Ratnabhadra, Aśvapati Kubera, Samyakjña, Drogaṇāga, Pañcika, Kṛīḍāvṛtta) are reconstructed from their Tibetan phonetic or semantic equivalents and may vary from their canonical Sanskrit forms.

- Many of the names of the twenty-eight commanders and thirty-two mighty ones in this passage appear to be transliterations, corruptions, or Tibetan phonetic renderings of Sanskrit names that cannot be reliably reconstructed with confidence. Where the Tibetan clearly gives a descriptive meaning, that meaning has been translated; where the name is opaque or a proper name only, it has been romanized as it appears. The final mantra syllable "ātmananīyad" is syntactically unclear and may be corrupt; it has been transliterated as found. The term

rendered "earthbound family" for sa ga'i rigs likely refers to a category of spirit beings associated with the earth, though the precise technical classification is uncertain. "Decayed bodies" renders lus srul po, a class of zombie-like or corpse-animated beings, sometimes identified with vetāla.

- The chapter colophon names the translator as "Rapzhi" (Rab zhi lo tsā ba) working with the Kashmiri paṇḍita Dānagupta at Tholing (Tho ling), the great monastery of western Tibet, which situates this translation in the late tenth to early eleventh century Tibetan renaissance period. The phrase "lhun gyis grub pa'i gtsug lag tho ling rgyan du" is rendered as "the monastery of Spontaneous Accomplishment, Tholing, as an ornament," meaning Tholing was graced or adorned by this translation work. The mantra syllables are transliterated as faithfully as the Tibetan orthography permits; some forms are irregular and may reflect transmission variants.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.